

If statements & Reading Input

Sometimes, you want to have a script that does the same CORE thing, but *slightly different* depending on what the user needs.

Reading user input, and combining that with *if statements* allows us to save from making MULTIPLE scripts that do similar things.

Let's make a script, called *backup_work*. That asks the user if they want to backup today's EDITED files, or today's ACCESSED files.

```
> read -p "Do you want to backup everything you edited today? (type in e),  
or accessed (type in a)?" answer
```

`read -p` gets user, and saves the input at the end in our VARIABLE, `answer`.

```
read -p "Do you want to backup everything you edited (e) today? Or everything you accessed (a) today?" answer
```

Let's DO something, with this input.

```
> if [ "$answer" = "e" ]; then THIS, does whatever is BELOW and indented,  
only if the user inputted e as their answer.
```

```
> find ~ -type f -mtime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null
```

- The KEY thing here, is `-mtime 0` for files MODIFIED today.

The *only thing* that should be new here is `-exec cp {} ~/backups \;`

- The `-exec` runs the command in front of it.
- This `cp {} ~/backups`, copies every file into the backups folder. `{}` is a placeholder for EVERY file in the find command with the destination of the backups folder.
- the `\;` tells the program it's done with `"-exec"`

```
if [ "$answer" = "e" ]; then  
    find ~ -type f -mtime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null
```

Now, what if instead; we put in "a"?

> `elif [ "$answer" = "a" ]; then` THIS, is ELSE IF; meaning *if the first one isn't the case, check if this one is true*. Then do what is below.

> `find ~ -type f -atime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null`

- The KEY thing here, is `-atime 0` for files *ACCESSED* today.

```
elif [ "$answer" = "a" ]; then
    find ~ -type f -atime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null
fi
```

Now we have to CLOSE the if statement, which is done by typing if backwards

Our file should end up like this.

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
read -p "Do you want to backup everything you edited (e) today? Or everything you accessed (a) today?" answer

mkdir -p ~/backups 2>/dev/null # Makes the backup folder, only if it doesn't exist. If it does, continues.

if [ "$answer" = "e" ]; then
    find ~ -type f -mtime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null
elif [ "$answer" = "a" ]; then
    find ~ -type f -atime 0 -exec cp {} ~/backups \; 2>/dev/null
fi

echo "Backed up files."
```

Now, you have the MAJORITY of the skills needed for basic bash scripts. Now you have the 5th PDF left; *INLINE arguments*, AUTOMATION, and syntax.